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Xi Jinping has introduced a number of significant departures from Deng's policy prescriptions during the decade of his rule. First and foremost, Xi has brought the Party front and centre as the source of all political power within the country and with supreme authority exercised by the Party's top leader. The notion of collective leadership and avoidance of a personality cult around the top leader have been set aside. Xi has been projecting himself as a leader in the same league as Mao Zedong and demanding loyalty to himself as a marker of loyalty to the Party. He has amended the Constitution to remove the two terms imposed on the office of the President. Since the Party Constitution does not impose formal limits on the office of the Party General Secretary, Xi can afford to ignore the informal limits on age and tenure and remain in office as long as he wishes. The political reforms brought about by Deng have been reversed and his warning against the rise of a personality cult around a Party leader has been ignored.

Xi Jinping has virtually erased the distinction between the state bureaucracy and the Party. The Party does not only perform a supervisory role over organs of the state, it is also now both participant and supervisor. Soon after taking office, Xi established a number of leading groups and commissions chaired by himself and composed of both Party functionaries and bureaucrats. For example, the Central Commission on Foreign Affairs, which was earlier the Leading Group on Foreign Affairs, is chaired by Xi but has the State Councillor in charge of foreign affairs. The Foreign Minister is part of the group. The Party's International Liaison Department, which handles relations with foreign, communist and other political parties, is also included. There is a National Security Commission, also headed by Xi, which is responsible for the whole gamut of security-related issues. The State Council under the Premier has been reduced to a subordinate implementing agency. Xi has been described, appropriately, as 'Chairman of Everything'.

It is the dynamism of China's private sector which has contributed to the